

NORTHBRIDGE FC

Football Operations & Performance Report 2024/25

For the year ended 30 June 2025

Bristol, England

First Team • Coaching • Recruitment • Performance • Academy • Women's Football

Community • Ambition • Excellence

Fictional internal knowledge-base document. All players, staff, performance figures and sporting records are fictional.

1. Football Operations Executive Summary

Northbridge FC finished seventh in the Premier League during 2024/25 and qualified for European football. The season represented a strong step forward for the Club, combining competitive league performance with continued squad development and investment in football infrastructure.

Head Coach Daniel Ashford led the first team, supported by Assistant Head Coach Rory McKenna and First-Team Coach Liam Duarte. Sporting Director Adrian Mercer was responsible for the longer-term football strategy, recruitment structure and alignment between the first team, academy and wider football operation.

The football department uses a multidisciplinary performance model combining coaching, recruitment, sports science, medical care, opposition analysis and performance data. The objective is to improve player availability and performance while maintaining a sustainable squad-building strategy.

2024/25 sporting snapshot

Measure	Northbridge position
Premier League finish	7th
European qualification	Achieved
Head Coach	Daniel Ashford
Sporting Director	Adrian Mercer
Gross player acquisitions	£43.0m
Gross player disposals	£34.0m
Player & staff wages	£88.0m
First-team squad	23 players in canonical roster
Academy Director	Samuel Okafor

2. Football Leadership

Person	Role	Responsibility
Adrian Mercer	Sporting Director	Long-term football strategy and squad planning
Daniel Ashford	Head Coach	First-team performance and match preparation
Rory McKenna	Assistant Head Coach	Coaching and tactical implementation
Liam Duarte	First-Team Coach	Technical/tactical development
Marcus Bell	Head of Recruitment	Scouting and recruitment
Priya Nair	Head of Performance	Physical and performance strategy
Dr Ethan Brooks	Medical Director	Medical governance
Dr Sofia Marin	First-Team Doctor	Player medical care
Caleb Hughes	Head of Sports Science	Physical performance and data
Samuel Okafor	Academy Director	Youth pathway

Person	Role	Responsibility
Helen Price	Women's Football Director	Women's football strategy

The Club separates long-term sporting strategy from first-team coaching responsibility. Adrian Mercer owns the wider football plan, while Daniel Ashford has operational responsibility for the first team.

3. First-Team Squad Profile

No.	Player	Position	Primary role
1	Ethan Cole	GK	First-choice goalkeeper
13	Mateo Varga	GK	Second-choice goalkeeper
31	Owen Price	GK	Development goalkeeper
2	Callum Reid	RB	Starting full-back
3	Ben Carter	LB	Starting left-back
4	Luka Petrovic	CB	Senior defensive leader
5	Marcus Doyle	CB	Experienced centre-back
6	Jonas Lindström	CB	Progressive centre-back
15	Aaron Mitchell	CB	Young defensive option
22	Theo Grant	RB/LB	Utility full-back
8	Daniel Mercer	CM	Central midfield controller
10	Rafael Costa	AM	Creative attacking midfielder
14	Noah Williams	CM	Box-to-box midfielder
16	Ibrahim Diallo	DM	Defensive midfielder
18	Leo Hart	CM	Young midfield option
7	Samuel Brooks	RW	Right-sided attacker
11	Nico Alvarez	LW	Primary wide threat
17	Kieran Walsh	LW/RW	Wide rotation option
19	Milan Kovac	AM/RW	Attacking rotation
9	Oliver Bennett	ST	Senior striker
20	Yusuf Demir	ST	Forward rotation
21	Jack Rowan	ST	Young striker
24	Thomas King	FW	Development forward

4. Preferred Sporting Model

Daniel Ashford's Northbridge side is built around controlled possession, aggressive counter-pressing and flexible positional rotations. The system is intended to allow the team to dominate territory without

becoming structurally exposed during transitions.

Phase	Operating principle
Build-up	Centre-backs and holding midfielder create controlled first phase
Progression	Full-backs provide width while midfield rotates
Final third	Wide players attack inside/outside channels
Pressing	Immediate pressure after losing possession
Defensive block	Compact midfield and protection of central areas
Transition	Quick forward progression after recoveries

The exact formation varies by opponent. The default structure is a 4-3-3 that can become a 4-2-3-1 in possession or a more compact 4-4-2 without the ball.

5. Key Player Roles

Player	Operational role
Ethan Cole	Controls defensive line and starts build-up
Luka Petrovic	Leads central defence and aerial organization
Daniel Mercer	Connects defensive and attacking phases
Ibrahim Diallo	Provides defensive balance
Rafael Costa	Creates chances between midfield and defence
Nico Alvarez	Provides width, penetration and final-third threat
Samuel Brooks	Attacks space and supports counter-pressing
Oliver Bennett	Central reference point and finishing threat

6. Training & Weekly Cycle

Day	Typical focus
MD+1	Recovery, medical assessment and match review
MD+2	Recovery / individualized work
MD-4	Technical and tactical development
MD-3	Opposition preparation and intensity
MD-2	Tactical rehearsal and set pieces
MD-1	Final tactical preparation and activation
MD	Matchday

Training schedules change according to fixture congestion, travel, European competition, player availability and individual load-management requirements.

7. Performance & Sports Science

Priya Nair and Caleb Hughes coordinate the performance function with the coaching and medical teams. Player workloads are monitored to balance training stimulus with recovery and injury risk.

Performance area	Operational use
GPS / workload data	Monitor physical load
Recovery monitoring	Identify fatigue and readiness
Strength & conditioning	Develop physical capacity
Injury prevention	Target individual risk factors
Match analysis	Evaluate tactical and physical output
Individual plans	Adapt work to player needs

Performance information is used as one input into selection and training decisions. It does not replace coaching judgement or medical assessment.

8. Medical Operations

Dr Sofia Marin leads first-team medical care, supported by the Club's performance and sports-science departments. Medical decisions are kept separate from commercial or sporting pressure where player welfare is involved.

Function	Responsibility
Medical assessment	Diagnose and assess player fitness
Rehabilitation	Return players safely to training
Injury prevention	Identify and reduce risk factors
Matchday care	Immediate treatment and escalation
Return-to-play	Coordinate medical, performance and coaching inputs
Player welfare	Confidential support and referral

9. Recruitment & Scouting

Marcus Bell leads recruitment. The Club's recruitment model combines traditional scouting, video analysis, performance data, character assessment, financial analysis and legal due diligence.

Stage	Decision input
Player identification	Scouting network + data
Initial assessment	Technical / tactical fit
Performance review	Data and video analysis
Character assessment	References and background information
Financial assessment	Fee, wages and long-term cost
Legal assessment	Contract, registration and regulatory review
Final decision	Sporting Director + Head Coach + executive approval

The £43.0m of gross player acquisitions in 2024/25 was therefore the output of a multi-stage process rather than a purely financial decision.

10. 2024/25 Transfer Activity

Metric	Result
Gross player acquisitions	£43.0m
Gross player disposals	£34.0m
Net transfer spend	£9.0m
Recruitment objective	Strengthen first team while protecting squad balance
Primary decision-makers	Adrian Mercer + Daniel Ashford

Transfer values in this report are gross accounting/transaction measures consistent with the Financial Analyst corpus. They do not represent a player's individual fee unless another document explicitly states

one.

11. Academy Pathway

Samuel Okafor leads the Academy. The pathway is designed to produce first-team players while supporting education, safeguarding, development and long-term player welfare.

Stage	Operational focus
Foundation	Technical development and enjoyment
Youth development	Technical, tactical and physical progression
Scholarship	Professional preparation + education
U21 pathway	Senior football exposure
First-team integration	Training and competitive opportunities

The Academy works closely with safeguarding, medical, performance and education staff. Academy recruitment is considered a long-term squad-building tool rather than a separate community program.

12. Women's Football

Helen Price leads women's football strategy. The women's operation shares Club-wide standards while maintaining competition-specific sporting planning.

Area	Operating model
First team	Dedicated coaching and performance structure
Recruitment	Scouting and squad planning
Academy/pathway	Development of future players
Medical	Club medical support
Commercial	Integrated with wider Club partnership strategy
Community	Participation and local engagement

13. Opposition Analysis & Match Preparation

The coaching and analysis team prepares opponent-specific plans using video, tactical data and recent match evidence.

Analysis	Question
Build-up	How does the opponent progress the ball?
Pressing	Where can Northbridge force turnovers?
Chance creation	Which spaces are most dangerous?
Set pieces	What patterns and vulnerabilities exist?
Transitions	How quickly does the opponent counter?
Individual threats	Which players require specific attention?

14. 2024/25 Sporting Performance

Area	Assessment
Premier League finish	7th
European qualification	Achieved
Sporting direction	Positive progression
Squad strategy	Balanced experience + development
Recruitment	£43m gross acquisitions / £34m disposals
Development priority	Improve consistency against top-six opposition

The seventh-place finish is treated as a strong result, but the football department identified consistency against the highest-ranked opponents and depth during fixture congestion as areas for improvement.

15. Football Operations Risk Register

Risk	Level	Control
Player injury / availability	Key	Medical + performance monitoring
Squad depth	Key	Recruitment and academy planning
Tactical inconsistency	Secondary	Training and opposition analysis
Transfer failure	Key	Multi-stage recruitment process
Fixture congestion	Key	Load management and squad rotation
Academy pathway disruption	Secondary	Long-term development planning
Coaching transition	Secondary	Sporting Director continuity

16. Football Decision-Making Flow

Sporting objective → squad/performance assessment → coaching and recruitment input → financial assessment → legal/regulatory review → Sporting Director recommendation → executive approval where required → implementation → performance monitoring.

This structure deliberately links football decisions to the Financial Analyst and Legal personas. For example, a player renewal can require football-performance evidence, wage information and contract/legal analysis before the final decision.

17. Player Performance Review

Review area	Examples
Technical	Passing, ball retention, finishing, defending
Tactical	Positioning, decision-making and system execution
Physical	Load, speed, endurance and availability
Mental / behavioural	Training standards and competitive response
Development	Progress against individual objectives
Team contribution	Role execution and tactical fit

18. Football Operations Outlook

- Improve consistency in high-level fixtures.
- Maintain a balanced squad as European football increases fixture demands.
- Continue developing Daniel Mercer, Nico Alvarez and other core first-team players.
- Increase academy-to-first-team progression.
- Strengthen recruitment integration between data, scouting and coaching.
- Protect player availability through individualized performance and medical planning.

19. General / Operations Analyst Questions

- Who is Northbridge's Head Coach?
- Who is the Sporting Director?
- What is Daniel Ashford's footballing approach?
- Who are Northbridge's key first-team players?
- Who is the first-choice goalkeeper?
- What position does Daniel Mercer play?
- What role does Rafael Costa have?
- Who is Northbridge's main striker?
- How does Northbridge's recruitment process work?
- How much did Northbridge spend on gross player acquisitions in 2024/25?
- What was Northbridge's net transfer spend?

- Who leads the Academy?
- Who leads women's football?
- How does the medical and performance department support the first team?
- What were Northbridge's main sporting weaknesses in 2024/25?
- How does the Sporting Director interact with the Head Coach?
- What are the main football operational risks?

Cross-document consistency

This report uses the canonical personnel universe established in the Club Operations & Organizational Report. It is intentionally connected to the Financial Analyst and Legal personas: player wages and transfer values should align with the financial corpus, while contracts, registrations and agent matters should align with the legal corpus.

All players, coaches, sporting statistics, tactical descriptions and performance assessments are fictional. The document is intended for retrieval, cross-document reasoning and version-aware RAG testing.